

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4**PART A Group Interaction**

This article appeared in a newspaper in Australia:

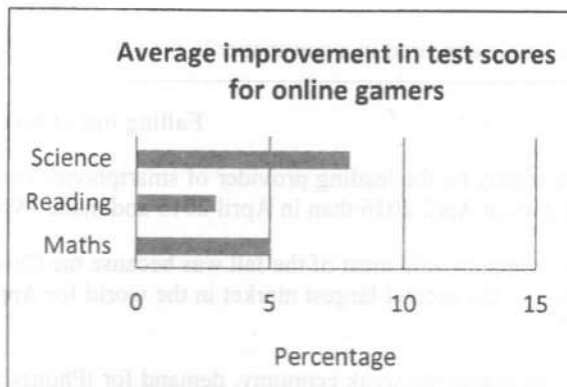
Teens who play online games perform better in school

Teenagers who play online games every day are more likely to get higher grades in school, a new Australian study based on the results of 12,000 students has found.

The goal of the study – published in the International Journal of Communication – was to investigate the effect playing online games had on teenagers and whether it affected their education.

Chief researcher, Dr Posso, stated, “Although there may be some problems with students spending too long playing games, it is possible that a number of skills learnt from online gaming help improve knowledge and skills in some important school subjects.”

The reasoning is that online games generally ask players to solve puzzles, which require skills in maths, reading and science. “When you play online games, you’re solving puzzles to move to the next level and that involves using some of the general knowledge and skills that you’ve been taught in the classroom,” Dr Posso added.



The Student Union wants to introduce an Online Games Day at school. You are meeting to discuss this. You may want to talk about:

- the benefits of playing online games
- possible activities for the Online Games Day
- problems you may face setting up an Online Games Day
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you play online games?
2. Would you like your school to use more games during lessons?
3. Do older people worry too much about teenagers playing online games?
4. Do you think online games help your reading and maths skills?
5. What other activities help improve reading and maths skills?
6. Do you agree that students benefit from playing online games?
7. Do you think all online games are beneficial?
8. Will online games become a bigger part of school life in the future?